

Channel representations of noisy coherent detection in continuous-variable quantum key distribution: Additive noise versus attenuator

A. S. Naumchik,^{1,*} Roman K. Goncharov,^{1,†} and Alexei D. Kiselev^{2,3,‡}

¹*ITMO University, Kronverksky Pr. 49, Saint Petersburg 197101, Russia*

²*Laboratory for Quantum Communications, ITMO University,
Birzhevaya Line, 16, Saint Petersburg 199034, Russia*

³*Laboratory of Quantum Processes and Measurements,
ITMO University, Kadetskaya Line 3b, Saint Petersburg 199034, Russia*

(Dated: July 21, 2026)

We study the security of continuous-variable quantum key distribution (CV-QKD) under asymmetric coherent detection in an untrusted-noise scenario. Building on our previous POVM-based description of homodyne and double-homodyne receivers, we replace the additive-noise channel with attenuator channel. For both homodyne and double-homodyne detection, we derive the corresponding Gaussian-channel parameters and compare the resulting Holevo information and asymptotic secret fraction with those obtained from the additive-noise model.

Our analysis shows that, while both channel models under asymmetry yield degraded protocol performance, the attenuator model gives less pessimistic security bounds.

In the double-homodyne case, due to the dependence on the squeezing parameter that describes ideal measurements, channel parameters and thereby informational quantities defining secure key rate are dependent on this squeezing parameter. The dependence of Holevo information on squeezing parameter is drastically different for the channel models, being concave for additive noise channel and convex for attenuator channel. It follows that for this type of measurement, choice of both squeezing parameter value and channel representation affects the resulting secure key rate.

I. INTRODUCTION

Homodyne and double-homodyne (heterodyne) detection are standard coherent-detection schemes in continuous-variable quantum optics and quantum information [1–3]. Homodyne detection measures a single field quadrature, whereas double-homodyne detection implements a joint Gaussian measurement of two conjugate quadratures. These schemes constitute the measurement stage in a broad class of continuous-variable quantum-communication protocols, including protocols for continuous-variable quantum key distribution (CV-QKD) [4–6], quantum state tomography [7, 8] and quantum state preparation [9].

A practical coherent receiver deviates from its idealized description because of nonunit photodetector efficiencies, electronic noise, beam-splitter imbalance, and mismatched responses of the detection branches. Such imperfections modify the conditional probability distribution of Bob’s outcome for a given incoming optical state and must therefore be included in the measurement model used in a security analysis [10–14]. Both ideal and imperfect coherent measurements are naturally described by positive operator-valued measures (POVMs). In the Gaussian regime, receiver imperfections give rise to noisy Gaussian POVMs.

For the class of noisy Gaussian measurements considered here, the measurement statistics can be represented either by applying a Gaussian channel to the incoming state before an ideal measurement or, equivalently, by applying the dual channel to the ideal POVM [15, 16]. This representation is particularly useful in CV-QKD because it incorporates receiver imperfections into the same Gaussian formalism used to model propagation and to evaluate the information available to an eavesdropper. Two natural Gaussian channels are the additive-noise channel and the attenuator channel. The former adds a zero-mean Gaussian random displacement whose quadratures are uncorrelated with the input quadratures, whereas the latter mixes the input mode with an environmental mode at a beam splitter. The attenuator reduces to a pure-loss channel when the environmental mode is in the vacuum state [3, 17].

Equivalence at the level of measurement statistics does not, however, make different channels interchangeable in a security analysis. With suitable parameter choices and, where necessary, a deterministic invertible rescaling of the outcomes, distinct Gaussian channels may reproduce the same calibrated receiver statistics and hence the same Alice-Bob mutual information. Nevertheless, their complementary channels need not be equivalent, so the environmental systems available to an eavesdropper may differ. This distinction is relevant to both untrusted- and trusted-receiver

* Email address: naumchik95@gmail.com

† Email address: toloroloe@gmail.com

‡ Email address: alexei.d.kiselev@gmail.com

models. In an untrusted-receiver model, the environmental output of the detector-channel realization is conservatively included in Eve's system. In a trusted-receiver model, the corresponding environmental modes remain inside Bob's laboratory and are inaccessible to Eve. Thus, the trust assignment can change the Holevo information even when the observed receiver statistics remain unchanged [17–21]. As has been highlighted in a recent work [22], Gaussian channel representation choice, while describing the same physical reality, will significantly alter security estimates.

Previous studies have established that receiver imbalance and other nonidealities can bias channel-parameter estimation, reduce the secret-key rate, and create security gaps when omitted from the measurement model [10, 12–14]. These results motivate an investigation into how the security estimate changes when the same asymmetry-induced POVM is realized through different Gaussian channels. This approach separates the experimentally calibrated measurement model from the additional physical assumptions introduced by a particular channel realization.

In our previous work [23], we derived the Gaussian POVMs that account for beam-splitter imbalance and photodetector efficiency mismatch, collectively referred to as *asymmetry effects*, in homodyne and double-homodyne receivers. We represented the resulting measurement noise through an additive noise channel. For double-homodyne detection, the ideal Gaussian POVM was represented by a family of pure squeezed-state seeds, with the admissible interval of squeezing parameters fixed by the positivity of the excess-noise covariance matrix. Within the untrusted-noise model, this nonuniqueness made the Holevo information dependent on the squeezing parameter. Although mathematically direct, the additive-noise realization is not tied to a specific optical coupling mechanism and is not the only Gaussian realization compatible with the same noisy POVM.

In the present work, we construct and analyze an attenuator channel of the same asymmetric homodyne and double-homodyne POVMs and compare it with the additive noise channel. The channel parameters are obtained by requiring the dual channel to map the ideal POVM onto the target noisy POVM. For homodyne detection, the environmental mode is chosen to be in the vacuum state, so the attenuator takes the form of a pure-loss channel. For double-homodyne detection, the generally anisotropic measurement noise is reproduced using a pure Gaussian environmental state with unequal quadrature variances. The channels considered here therefore serve as detector-channel realizations of a fixed noisy measurement rather than as alternative models of the physical communication link.

We compare the two channels within the Gaussian-modulated coherent-state (GMCS) protocol [24] with reverse reconciliation in the asymptotic regime and evaluate the asymptotic secret fraction under collective Gaussian attacks [25, 26]. The GMCS protocol provides a natural setting for a direct covariance-matrix comparison of the two detector-channel realizations. In the security model adopted here, receiver asymmetry is treated as untrusted; accordingly, the environmental output of the selected realization is assigned to Eve. Finite-size effects, composable-security corrections, active detector attacks, and uncertainties in equipment calibration are outside the scope of the present work.

This paper is organized as follows. Section II, we briefly recall the formalism behind POVMs of asymmetrical homodyne and double homodyne measurement schemes established in Ref. [23]. In Sec. III, we establish equivalence between attenuator channel model primarily used in this work and additive noise channel model used in Ref. [23], and derive the coefficients of those Gaussian channels. In Sec. IV, we derive informational quantities defining asymptotic secret fraction in the GMCS protocol for both channel models and both coherent measurements schemes and compare the results. Finally, in Sec. V, we provide a discussion of the results as well as concluding remarks.

II. IMPERFECT GAUSSIAN MEASUREMENTS

We begin with a brief discussion of asymmetrical coherent measurements, schematically depicted in Fig. 1. Asymmetry effects are induced by imbalance (unequal transmission and reflection coefficients) of the beamsplitters and unequal quantum efficiency of the detectors. For detailed derivations of the expressions in this section see Ref. [23].

Q symbol of the POVM describing noisy homodyne measurements (see Fig. 1a) is given by

$$P_G^{(H)}(x) = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi}\sigma_G} \exp\left[-\frac{(x - \langle\hat{x}_\phi\rangle)^2}{2\sigma_x}\right], \quad (1)$$

$$\langle\hat{x}_\phi\rangle \equiv \langle\alpha|\hat{x}_\phi|\alpha\rangle = 2\operatorname{Re}\alpha e^{-i\phi}, \quad \phi = \arg\alpha_L, \quad (2)$$

$$\hat{x}_\phi = \hat{a}e^{-i\phi} + \hat{a}^\dagger e^{i\phi} \quad (3)$$

where α (α_L) is the complex amplitude of signal (LO) mode, $\hat{x}_\phi$ is the phase-rotated quadrature operator; x is the quadrature variable

$$x \equiv \frac{\mu}{(\eta_1 + \eta_2)CS|\alpha_L|} - \frac{\eta_1 S^2 - \eta_2 C^2}{(\eta_1 + \eta_2)CS}|\alpha_L| \quad (4)$$

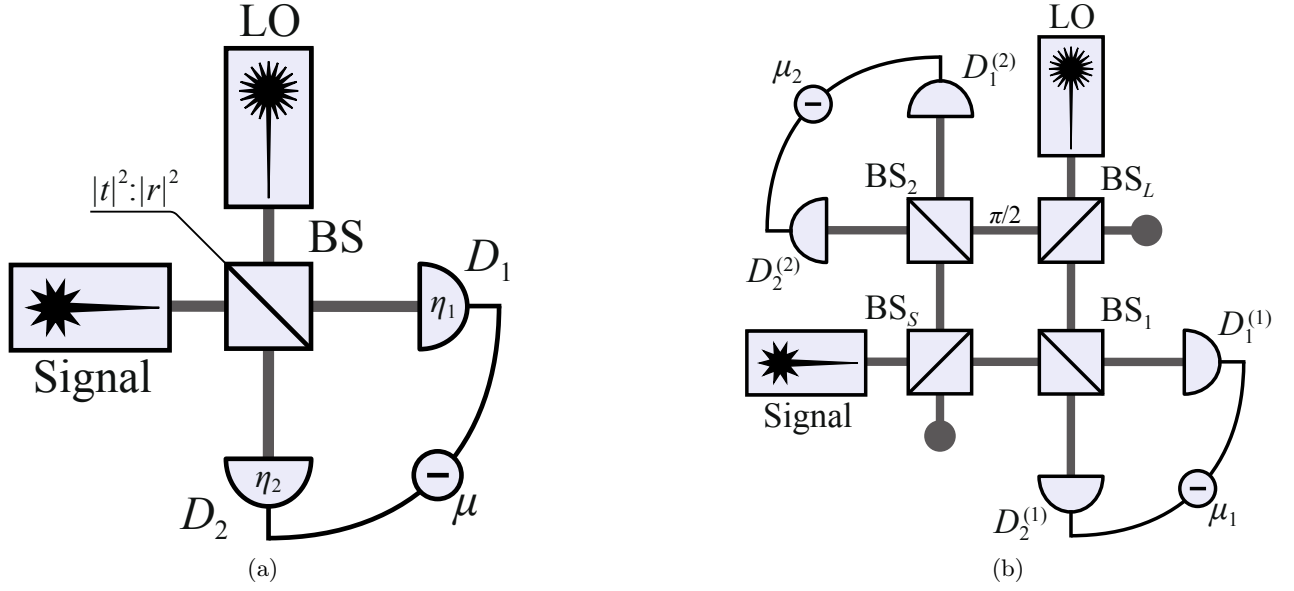


Figure 1: (a) Scheme of homodyne receiver. S (LO) is the source of signal (reference) mode, BS is the beamsplitter with transmission and reflection coefficients C and S , respectively; photodetectors D_1 and D_2 have quantum efficiencies η_1 and η_2 , and $\mu = m_1 - m_2$ is the photon count difference. (b) Scheme of double homodyne receiver. S (LO) is the source of signal (reference) mode, BS_S (BS_L) is the signal mode (local oscillator) beam splitter; $\pi/2$ is the quarter wave phase shifter; BS_i is the beam splitter of i th homodyne; $D_{1,2}^{(i)}$ are the photodetectors of the i th homodyne; and $\mu_i = m_1^{(i)} - m_2^{(i)}$ is the photon count difference registered by the detectors of i th homodyne.

and σ_x is the quadrature variance

$$\sigma_x \equiv \frac{\eta_1 S^2 + \eta_2 C^2}{[(\eta_1 + \eta_2)CS]^2}. \quad (5)$$

By computing inverse Fourier transform of Q symbol (1), we obtain anti-normal ordered characteristic function [16]. From this characteristic function we can deduce the covariance matrix of the noisy homodyne measurements as follows

$$\Sigma_m^{(H)} = \lim_{r \rightarrow +\infty} R(\phi) \text{diag}(e^{-2r} + \sigma_N, e^{2r}) R^T(\phi), \quad (6)$$

$$\Sigma_{\text{id}}^{(H)} = \lim_{r \rightarrow +\infty} R(\phi) \text{diag}(e^{-2r}, e^{2r}) R^T(\phi), \quad (7)$$

where $\Sigma_{\text{id}}^{(H)}$ is the covariance matrix of ideal homodyne measurement, $R(\phi) = \begin{pmatrix} \cos \phi & -\sin \phi \\ \sin \phi & \cos \phi \end{pmatrix}$ is the rotation matrix; σ_N is the excess noise variance that accounts for asymmetry effects is given by

$$\sigma_N = \sigma_x - 1. \quad (8)$$

For double homodyne detection, Q symbol is given by

$$P_G^{(\text{DH})}(x_1, x_2) = \frac{1}{2\pi\sqrt{\sigma_G^{(1)}\sigma_G^{(2)}}} \exp\left[-\frac{(x_1 - \text{Re } \alpha e^{-i\phi})^2}{\sigma_1} - \frac{(x_2 - \text{Im } \alpha e^{-i\phi})^2}{\sigma_2}\right], \quad (9)$$

$$\sigma_G^{(i)} = (\eta_1^{(i)} S_i^2 + \eta_2^{(i)} C_i^2) |\alpha_L^{(i)}|^2, \quad \alpha_L^{(1)} = C_L \alpha_L, \quad \alpha_L^{(2)} = -i S_L \alpha_L, \quad (10)$$

where x_i are the quadrature variables given by

$$x_1 = \frac{1}{2(\eta_1^{(1)} + \eta_2^{(1)})C_1 S_1 C_S} \left\{ \frac{\mu_1}{|\alpha_L^{(1)}|} - (\eta_1^{(1)} S_1^2 - \eta_2^{(1)} C_1^2) |\alpha_L^{(1)}| \right\}, \quad (11)$$

$$x_2 = \frac{1}{2(\eta_1^{(2)} + \eta_2^{(2)})C_2 S_2 S_S} \left\{ \frac{\mu_2}{|\alpha_L^{(2)}|} - (\eta_1^{(2)} S_2^2 - \eta_2^{(2)} C_2^2) |\alpha_L^{(2)}| \right\}, \quad (12)$$

and relations

$$\sigma_1 = \frac{\sigma_x^{(1)}}{2C_S^2}, \quad \sigma_2 = \frac{\sigma_x^{(2)}}{2S_S^2}, \quad (13)$$

$$\sigma_x^{(i)} = \frac{\eta_1^{(i)} S_i^2 + \eta_2^{(i)} C_i^2}{\left[(\eta_1^{(i)} + \eta_2^{(i)}) C_i S_i \right]^2} \quad (14)$$

give the quadrature variances σ_1 and σ_2 .

Following the same procedure used to derive Eq. (6), we obtain the covariance matrix of the double homodyne POVM,

$$\Sigma_m^{(\text{DH})} = R(\phi) \text{diag}(\delta_1, \delta_2) R^T(\phi), \quad (15)$$

$$\delta_i = 2\sigma_i - 1. \quad (16)$$

The POVM that describes ideal double homodyne measurements uses the set of squeezed states,

$$|z, r, \phi\rangle = \hat{R}(\phi) \hat{D}(z) \hat{S}(r) |0\rangle = \hat{D}(ze^{i\phi}) \hat{S}(re^{2i\phi}) |0\rangle, \quad (17)$$

where z is the coherent state amplitude, r is real-valued squeezing parameter, and ϕ is squeezing phase, $\hat{D}(z) = e^{z\hat{a}^\dagger - z^*\hat{a}}$ is the displacement operator, and $\hat{S}(r) = e^{\frac{1}{2}(r\hat{a}^{\dagger 2} - r^*\hat{a}^2)}$ is the squeezing operator.

The covariance matrix of squeezed states reads

$$\Sigma_{\text{id}}^{(\text{DH})} = R(\phi) \begin{pmatrix} e^{2r} & 0 \\ 0 & e^{-2r} \end{pmatrix} R^T(\phi). \quad (18)$$

An important point is that, for the difference between covariance matrices of noisy and ideal double homodyne measurements, given by Eq. (15) and Eq. (18) respectively, is positive semi-definite, the squeezing parameter r must be ranged in the interval defined by parameters of the scheme (see Ref. [23])

$$r \in [r_2, r_1], \quad r_1 = \ln \delta_1^{1/2}, \quad r_2 = \ln \delta_2^{-1/2}. \quad (19)$$

III. GAUSSIAN CHANNELS MODELING IMPERFECT MEASUREMENTS

For arbitrary state $\hat{\rho}$ and POVM $\hat{\Pi}^{(x)}$, the outcome probability is [27]

$$p(x|\hat{\rho}) = \text{Tr} \left(\hat{\rho} \hat{\Pi}^{(x)} \right). \quad (20)$$

The measurement statistics of Gaussian states with noisy Gaussian measurements can be calculated by applying the noise map $\mathcal{C}$ to ρ_G , or the dual map $\mathcal{C}^*$ to the ideal POVM $\hat{\Pi}_{\text{id}}$ [16], i.e.

$$p(x|\hat{\rho}_G) = \text{Tr} \left\{ \mathcal{C}(\hat{\rho}_G) \hat{\Pi}_{\text{id}}^{(x)} \right\} = \text{Tr} \left\{ \hat{\rho}_G \mathcal{C}^* \left(\hat{\Pi}_{\text{id}}^{(x)} \right) \right\}. \quad (21)$$

An important property is that the same measurement statistics can be described by different Gaussian channels $\mathcal{C}$, provided their dual maps $\mathcal{C}^*$ yield the same covariance matrix. While the first moments will differ, it is not as crucial due to being able to rescale them.

Note that, as measurements are specified to be Gaussian, the channels $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{C}^*$ will be Gaussian as well. It follows that the channel $\mathcal{C}$ is fully characterized by matrices $X_{\mathcal{C}}$ and $Y_{\mathcal{C}}$, transforming the first and second moments of Gaussian state ρ_G , $\mathbf{r}_G$ and Σ_G respectively, as follows [28]

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{r}_G &\mapsto X_{\mathcal{C}} \mathbf{r}_G, \\ \Sigma_G &\mapsto X_{\mathcal{C}} \Sigma_G X_{\mathcal{C}}^T + Y_{\mathcal{C}}. \end{aligned} \quad (22)$$

The dual channel $\mathcal{C}^*$ transforming the first and second moments as follows

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{r}_G &\mapsto X_{\mathcal{C}}^{-1} \mathbf{r}_G, \\ \Sigma_G &\mapsto X_{\mathcal{C}}^{-1} \Sigma (X_{\mathcal{C}}^{-1})^T + X_{\mathcal{C}}^{-1} Y_{\mathcal{C}} (X_{\mathcal{C}}^{-1})^T. \end{aligned} \quad (23)$$

In what follows, we will consider two distinct quantum channels to describe the imperfect measurements, namely additive noise channel and attenuator channel. In accordance with Eq. (21), channel $\mathcal{C}$ will be defined in a way that its' dual channel $\mathcal{C}^*$ will transform the covariance matrix of ideal measurement Σ_{id} into the covariance matrix of noisy Gaussian measurement Σ_m ,

$$\mathcal{C}^* : \Sigma_{\text{id}}^{(\gamma)} \mapsto \Sigma_m^{(\gamma)} \quad (24)$$

A. Additive noise channel

First, we consider additive noise (classical mixing) channel [16] Φ_γ , characterized by matrices

$$X_\Phi^{(\gamma)} = \mathbb{1}, \quad Y_\Phi^{(\gamma)} \geq 0, \quad \gamma \in \{\text{H}, \text{DH}\}. \quad (25)$$

This is a self-dual channel, $\Phi_\gamma^* = \Phi_\gamma$, that does not affect the first moment and changes the second moment as follows

$$\Phi_\gamma : \Sigma \mapsto \Sigma + Y_\Phi^{(\gamma)}. \quad (26)$$

To find matrices $Y_\Phi^{(\gamma)}$ so that (see Eq. (24))

$$\Phi_\gamma : \Sigma_{\text{id}}^{(\gamma)} \mapsto \Sigma_m^{(\gamma)} = \Sigma_{\text{id}}^{(\gamma)} + Y_\Phi^{(\gamma)}, \quad (27)$$

we need to find the difference between covariance matrices of noisy and ideal measurements, i.e.

$$Y_\Phi^{(\gamma)} = \Sigma_m^{(\gamma)} - \Sigma_{\text{id}}^{(\gamma)} \equiv \Sigma_N^{(\gamma)}, \quad (28)$$

where we defined the covariance matrix of excess noise $\Sigma_N^{(\gamma)}$.

For homodyne detection, from Eq. (7) and (6), we have

$$\Sigma_N^{(\text{H})} = \Sigma_m^{(\text{H})} - \Sigma_{\text{id}}^{(\text{H})} = R(\phi) \text{diag}(\sigma_N, 0) R^T(\phi) \geq 0, \quad (29)$$

where σ_N is given by Eq. (8).

For double homodyne detection, from Eq. (15) and (18), we have

$$\Sigma_N^{(\text{DH})}(r) = \Sigma_m^{(\text{DH})} - \Sigma_{\text{id}}^{(\text{DH})} = R(\phi) \begin{pmatrix} \sigma_N^{(1)}(r) & 0 \\ 0 & \sigma_N^{(2)}(r) \end{pmatrix} R^T(\phi) \geq 0, \quad (30)$$

$$\sigma_N^{(1)}(r) = \delta_1 - e^{2r}, \quad \sigma_N^{(2)}(r) = \delta_2 - e^{-2r}. \quad (31)$$

Note that the elements of $\Sigma_N^{(\text{DH})}$ are dependent on squeezing parameter that lies in the interval (19). When $r \in [r_2, r_1]$, it is certain that the covariance matrix of excess noise is positive semi-definite, $\Sigma_N^{(\text{DH})}(r) \geq 0$.

B. Attenuator channel

We shall move on to the attenuator channel $\mathcal{E}_\gamma$, characterized by matrices [16]

$$X_\mathcal{E}^{(\gamma)} = \cos \theta_\gamma \mathbb{1}, \quad Y_\mathcal{E}^{(\gamma)} = \sin^2 \theta_\gamma \Sigma_{\text{env}}^{(\gamma)}, \quad \gamma \in \{\text{H}, \text{DH}\}, \quad (32)$$

where $\Sigma_{\text{env}}^{(\gamma)}$ is the covariance matrix of the state describing the environment.

Using Eq. (24) together with Eq. (22), we construct the dual channel $\mathcal{E}_N^{*(\gamma)}$ so that it transforms the POVM of the ideal measurement into the POVM of the noisy measurements by changing the covariance matrix $\Sigma_{\text{id}}^{(\gamma)}$ into $\Sigma_m^{(\gamma)}$ as follows

$$\mathcal{E}_\gamma^* : \Sigma_{\text{id}}^{(\gamma)} \mapsto \Sigma_m^{(\gamma)} = \frac{1}{\cos^2 \theta_\gamma} \Sigma_{\text{id}}^{(\gamma)} + \tan^2 \theta_\gamma \Sigma_{\text{env}}^{(\gamma)}, \quad \gamma \in \{\text{H}, \text{DH}\}. \quad (33)$$

First, we will consider homodyne detection. If the environment is described by vacuum, i.e.

$$\Sigma_{\text{env}}^{(\text{H})} = \mathbb{1}, \quad (34)$$

together with from matrices of ideal (7) and noisy (6) measurements, Eq. (33) takes the form

$$\Sigma_m^{(\text{H})} = \lim_{r \rightarrow +\infty} R(\phi) \text{diag}(e^{-2r} + \sigma_N, e^{2r}) R^T(\phi) = \lim_{r \rightarrow +\infty} \left\{ \frac{1}{\cos^2 \theta_H} R(\phi) \text{diag}(e^{-2r}, e^{2r}) R^T(\phi) + \tan^2 \theta_H \mathbb{1} \right\} \quad (35)$$

due to the limit $r \rightarrow \infty$, we may write

$$\frac{1}{\cos^2 \theta} \Sigma_{\text{id}}^{(\text{H})} \sim \Sigma_{\text{id}}^{(\text{H})}, \quad e^{2r} + \text{const} \sim e^{2r}, \quad (36)$$

it is sufficient to solve for $\tan^2 \theta_H$, i.e.

$$\tan^2 \theta_H = \sigma_N, \quad (37)$$

where σ_N is defined by Eq. (8). Then, $\cos^2 \theta_H$ and $\sin^2 \theta_H$ are given by

$$\cos^2 \theta_H = \frac{1}{\sigma_x}, \quad \sin^2 \theta_H = \frac{\sigma_N}{\sigma_x}. \quad (38)$$

For double homodyne detection, first, we note that, since $\Sigma_m^{(\text{DH})}$ is anisotropic, as generally quadrature variances $\delta_{1,2}$ are not equal, $\delta_1 \neq \delta_2$, environment state must be anisotropic as well. Without loss of generality, we will consider the environment to be in pure state with $\det \Sigma_{\text{env}}^{(\text{DH})} = 1$,

$$\Sigma_{\text{env}}^{(\text{DH})} = R(\phi) \text{diag} \left(a, \frac{1}{a} \right) R^T(\phi), \quad a \geq 0. \quad (39)$$

Solving Eq. (33) for the case of double homodyne detection, (see Eq. (18), (15)),

$$\Sigma_m^{(\text{DH})} = R(\phi) \text{diag}(\delta_1, \delta_2) R^T(\phi) = R(\phi) \left\{ \frac{1}{\cos^2 \theta_{\text{DH}}} \text{diag}(e^{2r}, e^{-2r}) + \tan^2 \theta_{\text{DH}} \text{diag} \left(a, \frac{1}{a} \right) \right\} R^T(\phi), \quad (40)$$

$$\begin{cases} \delta_1 = \frac{e^{2r}}{\cos^2 \theta_{\text{DH}}} + \tan^2 \theta_{\text{DH}} a \\ \delta_2 = \frac{e^{-2r}}{\cos^2 \theta_{\text{DH}}} + \tan^2 \theta_{\text{DH}} a^{-1} \end{cases}. \quad (41)$$

Solving the system yields

$$\cos^2 \theta_{\text{DH}}(r) = \frac{e^{2r} + a(r)}{\delta_1 + a(r)} = \frac{\delta_1 e^{-2r} + \delta_2 e^{2r} - 2}{\delta_1 \delta_2 - 1}, \quad (42)$$

$$a(r) = \frac{\delta_1 - e^{2r}}{\delta_2 e^{2r} - 1}. \quad (43)$$

Note that at the ends of the r -interval (19), $r \rightarrow r_2$ or $r \rightarrow r_1$, either $a(r)$ or $1/a(r)$ tend to infinity, making the ancilla state (39) the eigenstate of the quadrature operator (3). By evaluating in this case the equations (41), i.e. resolving indeterminate form $\tan^2 \theta_{\text{DH}} a(r)$ for $r = r_2$ and $\tan^2 \theta_{\text{DH}}/a(r)$ for $r = r_1$, because one of noise variances (31) would be 0, it can be seen that the effect of this channel would be the same as the effect of the additive noise channel (27) modeling double homodyne detection with the same r . This fact will be used in numerical calculations (see next section and Fig. 3).

IV. GAUSSIAN MODULATED COHERENT STATES PROTOCOL

In the Gaussian modulated coherent states (GMCS) protocol, Alice sends coherent states $|\alpha = \alpha_1 + i\alpha_2\rangle$ drawn from the Gaussian prior

$$p_A(\alpha) = \frac{1}{\pi V_A} \exp \left[-\frac{|\alpha|^2}{2V_A} \right]. \quad (44)$$

The states pass the composite Gaussian channel $\mathcal{N}_{A \rightarrow B} = \mathcal{L}_N \circ \mathcal{L}_{T_{\text{ch}}}$, where index indicates pure loss channel transmission coefficient, T_{ch} is the channel transmittance, $N = 1 + \xi_{\text{ch}}/(1 - T_{\text{ch}})$, and ξ_{ch} is the channel excess noise. Then, the receiver uses either homodyne or double homodyne detection to measure the states. Mutual information between legitimate parties in each case is then given by the following expressions (see Ref. [23] for derivation)

$$I_{\text{AB}}^{(\text{H})} = \frac{1}{2} \log \left[1 + \frac{4T_{\text{ch}}V_{\text{A}}}{\sigma_x + \xi_{\text{ch}}} \right], \quad (45)$$

$$I_{\text{AB}}^{(\text{DH})} = \frac{1}{2} \sum_i \log \left[1 + \frac{4T_{\text{ch}}V_{\text{A}}}{2\sigma_i + \xi_{\text{ch}}} \right], \quad (46)$$

where σ_x and σ_i given by Eqs. (5) and (14), respectively, and upper indices hereinafter stand for homodyne and double homodyne.

The covariance matrix of TMSV state with the Bob's mode transmitted through the noisy channel reads (see Ref. [29])

$$\mathcal{I}_A \otimes \mathcal{L}_N \circ \mathcal{L}_{T_{\text{ch}}} : \Sigma_{\text{TMSV}} = \begin{pmatrix} V\mathbb{1} & \sqrt{V^2 - 1}\sigma_z \\ \sqrt{V^2 - 1}\sigma_z & V\mathbb{1} \end{pmatrix} \mapsto \Sigma_{\text{AB}} = \begin{pmatrix} V\mathbb{1} & c\sigma_z \\ c\sigma_z & V_{\text{B}}\mathbb{1} \end{pmatrix}, \quad (47)$$

where $\mathcal{I}_A$ is the identity channel acting on the subsystem A and the parameters of the covariance matrix Σ_{AB} are given by

$$V = 1 + 4V_{\text{A}}, \quad c = \sqrt{T_{\text{ch}}(V^2 - 1)}, \quad (48)$$

$$V_{\text{B}} = T_{\text{ch}}(V - 1) + 1 + \xi_{\text{ch}}. \quad (49)$$

We consider local action of either attenuator channel $\mathcal{E}_\gamma$ (32) or additive noise channel Φ_γ (25), on second mode of TMSVS shared by Alice and Bob (47). In both cases, mutual information is given by $I_{\text{AB}}^{(\gamma)}$ (45), (46), as it is classical. It follows

$$\mathcal{I}_A \otimes \mathcal{E}_\gamma : \Sigma_{\text{AB}} \mapsto \Sigma_{\text{AB}}^{(\mathcal{E}_\gamma)} = \begin{pmatrix} V\mathbb{1} & c \cos \theta_\gamma \sigma_z \\ c \cos \theta_\gamma \sigma_z & \cos^2 \theta_\gamma (V_{\text{B}} + \tan^2 \theta_\gamma \Sigma_{\text{env}}^{(\gamma)}) \end{pmatrix}, \quad (50)$$

$$\mathcal{I}_A \otimes \Phi_N^{(\gamma)} : \Sigma_{\text{AB}} \mapsto \Sigma_{\text{AB}}^{(\Phi_\gamma)} = \begin{pmatrix} V\mathbb{1} & c\sigma_z \\ c\sigma_z & V_{\text{B}}\mathbb{1} + \Sigma_N^{(\gamma)} \end{pmatrix}, \quad \gamma \in \{\text{H}, \text{DH}\}. \quad (51)$$

When the channel $\mathcal{C}_\gamma \in \{\Phi_\gamma, \mathcal{E}_\gamma\}$ is under control of the eavesdropper, Eve holds a purification of the state $\hat{\rho}_{\text{AB}}^{(\mathcal{C}_\gamma)} = \mathcal{I}_A \otimes \mathcal{C}_\gamma(\hat{\rho}_{\text{AB}})$ and the measurements performed by the receiver are assumed to be noiseless. In this scenario, the difference between the joint and conditional entropies

$$\chi_{\text{EB}}^{(\mathcal{C}_\gamma)} = S_{\text{E}} - S_{\text{E}|\text{B}} = S_{\text{AB}}^{(\mathcal{C}_\gamma)} - S_{\text{A}|\text{B}}^{(\mathcal{C}_\gamma)}, \quad \mathcal{C}_\gamma \in \{\Phi_\gamma, \mathcal{E}_\gamma\}. \quad (52)$$

gives the Holevo information. The joint entropy

$$S_{\text{AB}}^{(\mathcal{C}_\gamma)} = g(\nu_1^{(\mathcal{C}_\gamma)}) + g(\nu_2^{(\mathcal{C}_\gamma)}), \quad (53)$$

$$g(\nu) = \frac{\nu + 1}{2} \log \frac{\nu + 1}{2} - \frac{\nu - 1}{2} \log \frac{\nu - 1}{2}$$

then can be expressed in terms of the symplectic eigenvalues of the covariance matrix (51) given by

$$\nu_{1,2}^{(\mathcal{C}_\gamma)} = \sqrt{\Delta_{\mathcal{C}_\gamma}/2 \pm \sqrt{\Delta_{\mathcal{C}_\gamma}^2/4 - D_{\mathcal{C}_\gamma}}}, \quad D_{\mathcal{C}_\gamma} = \det \Sigma_{\text{AB}}^{(\mathcal{C}_\gamma)}, \quad (54)$$

$$\Delta_{\mathcal{C}_\gamma} = \det([\Sigma_{\text{AB}}^{(\mathcal{C}_\gamma)}]_{11}) + \det([\Sigma_{\text{AB}}^{(\mathcal{C}_\gamma)}]_{22}) + 2 \det([\Sigma_{\text{AB}}^{(\mathcal{C}_\gamma)}]_{12}), \quad (55)$$

where $[\Sigma_{\text{AB}}^{(\mathcal{C}_\gamma)}]_{ii}$ ($[\Sigma_{\text{AB}}^{(\mathcal{C}_\gamma)}]_{ij}$) are diagonal (off-diagonal) blocks of $\Sigma_{\text{AB}}^{(\mathcal{C}_\gamma)}$.

Conditional entropies $S_{\text{E}|\text{B}} = S_{\text{A}|\text{B}}^{(\gamma)}$ are calculated from respective conditional covariance matrices,

$$S_{\text{A}|\text{B}}^{(\gamma)} = g(\nu_3^{(\gamma)}), \quad \nu_3^{(\gamma)} = \sqrt{\det \Sigma_{\text{A}|\text{B}}^{(\gamma)}}, \quad (56)$$

$$\Sigma_{\text{A}|\text{B}}^{(\gamma)} = V\mathbb{1} - c^2 \sigma_z (V_{\text{B}}\mathbb{1} + \Sigma_m^{(\gamma)})^{-1} \sigma_z. \quad (57)$$

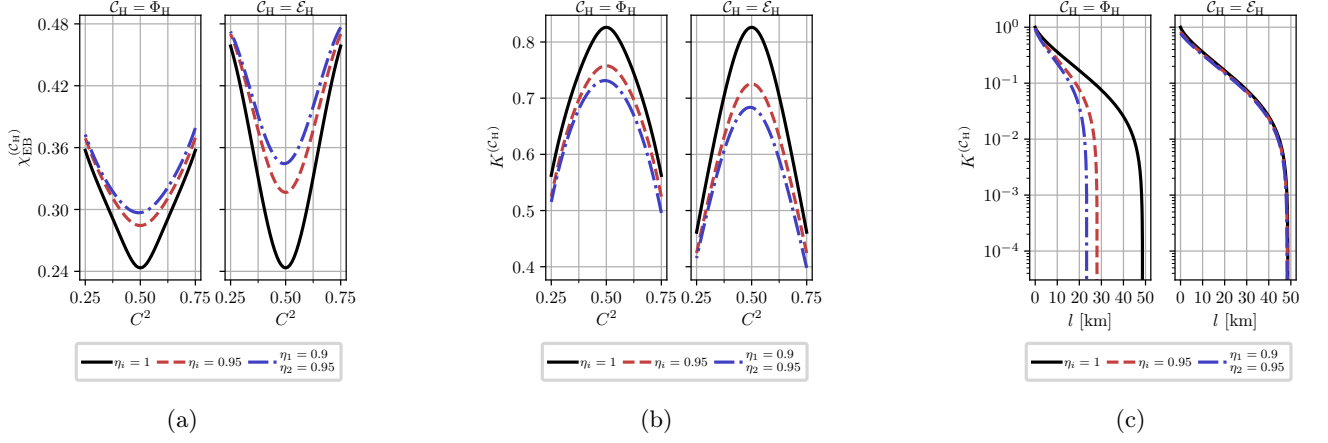


Figure 2: (a) Holevo information, $\chi_{EB}^{(\mathcal{C}_H)}$ and (b) asymptotic secret fraction, $K^{(\mathcal{C}_H)}$, as a function of the beam splitter transmission, C^2 , of the homodyne receiver computed at different values of the detector efficiencies for additive noise and attenuator channel models, as indicated in panel title. The parameters are: $V = 5$; $T_{ch} = 0.95$; $\xi_{ch} = 10^{-2}$; and $\beta = 0.95$. (c) $K^{(\mathcal{C}_H)}$ versus transmission length l for additive noise and attenuator channel models. The parameters are: $V = 5$; $\beta = 0.95$; $\xi_{ch} = 10^{-2}$; losses are 20 dB per 100 km.

Direct computations show that these conditional matrices and therefore their symplectic eigenvalues are independent on channel model. Symplectic eigenvalues are given by

$$\nu_3^{(H)} = \sqrt{V \left(V - \frac{c^2}{V_B + \sigma_N} \right)}, \quad (58)$$

$$\nu_3^{(DH)} = V \sqrt{\frac{(V_B + \delta_1 - \frac{c^2}{V})(V_B + \delta_2 - \frac{c^2}{V})}{(V_B + \delta_1)(V_B + \delta_2)}}, \quad (59)$$

From mutual information and Holevo information evaluation of the asymptotic secret fraction is done per Devetak-Winter formula [30]

$$K^{(\mathcal{C}_\gamma)} = \beta I_{AB}^{(\mathcal{C}_\gamma)} - \chi_{EB}^{(\mathcal{C}_\gamma)}, \quad \gamma \in \{H, DH\}, \mathcal{C}_\gamma \in \{\Phi_\gamma, \mathcal{E}_\gamma\}. \quad (60)$$

As symplectic eigenvalues for additive noise channel are calculated per formulas Eq. (54) and do not allow for simplification, in the following sections we focus only on analytic expressions for symplectic eigenvalues for attenuator channel model.

A. Homodyne detection

For attenuator channel, from Eq. (50) and (38) we have

$$\Sigma_{AB}^{(\mathcal{E}_H)} = \begin{pmatrix} V \mathbb{1} & \frac{c}{\sqrt{\sigma_x}} \sigma_z \\ \frac{c}{\sqrt{\sigma_x}} \sigma_z & \frac{1}{\sigma_x} (V_B + \sigma_N) \mathbb{1} \end{pmatrix} \equiv \begin{pmatrix} V \mathbb{1} & \tilde{c} \sigma_z \\ \tilde{c} \sigma_z & \tilde{V}_B \mathbb{1} \end{pmatrix}, \quad (61)$$

$$\tilde{V}_B \equiv T(V - 1) + 1 + \xi, \quad (62)$$

$$\tilde{c} \equiv \sqrt{T(V^2 - 1)}, \quad (63)$$

where we defined scaled Bob's variance and scaled correlations between Alice and Bob $\tilde{V}_B$ and $\tilde{c}$, using total channel transmission T that consists of channel transmission T_{ch} and detection losses $\frac{1}{\sigma_x}$, as well as scaled noise variance ξ ,

$$T = T_{ch} \cdot \frac{1}{\sigma_x}, \quad (64a)$$

$$\xi \equiv \xi_{ch} \cdot \frac{1}{\sigma_x}. \quad (64b)$$

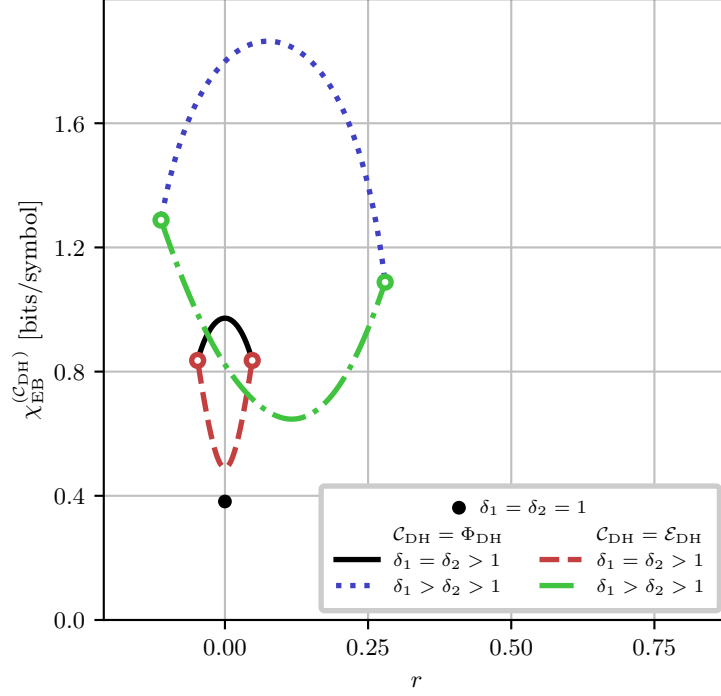


Figure 3: Holevo information, $\chi_{\text{EB}}^{(\text{DH}; \text{C}_{\text{DH}})}$, as a function of the squeezing parameter r at different values of $\delta_{1,2}$. Black dot corresponds to the case of perfect measurements. Solid and dashdotted curves correspond to additive noise channel model, while dashed and dotted curves are for attenuator channel model. Color-matched white-filled dots mark points where Holevo information is undefined at the boundaries of the r interval (19) (see Eq. (43) and main text). Values of $\delta_{1,2}$ are: $\delta_{1,2} = 1.1$ for solid and dashed curves, $\delta_1 = 1.75, \delta_2 = 1.25$ for dashdotted and dotted curves. The channel parameters are: $V = 5$; $T_{\text{ch}} = 0.95$; and $\xi_{\text{ch}} = 10^{-2}$.

It follows that for homodyne detection the effect of measurement asymmetry is equivalent to scaling both channel transmission (64a) and channel noise (64b) by a factor of σ_x^{-1} .

Symplectic eigenvalues of $\Sigma_{\text{AB}}^{(\mathcal{E}_{\text{H}})}$, $\nu_{1,2}^{(\mathcal{E}_{\text{H}})}$, can be computed using formulas [28]:

$$\nu_{1,2}^{(\mathcal{E}_{\text{H}})} = \frac{z \pm [\tilde{V}_{\text{B}} - V]}{2}, \quad z = \sqrt{(V + \tilde{V}_{\text{B}})^2 - 4\tilde{c}^2}, \quad (65)$$

and then substituted in Eq. (53) to calculate joint entropy $S_{\text{AB}}^{(\mathcal{E}_{\text{H}})}$.

Fig. 2 illustrates the effects of homodyne measurement asymmetry on Holevo information (52) and asymptotic secret fraction (60) versus beam splitter transmission C^2 , as well as secret fraction versus transmission length, for both additive noise (51) and attenuator (50) channels. While channel noise is reduced in this setup (64b), so is channel transmission (64a), and, since transmission is scaled by modulation variance $V \gg 1$ in every expression, as well as reduced mutual information with greater asymmetry per Eq. (45), attenuator channel has negative effect. As shown in Fig. 2a and 2b, the attenuator channel results in higher Holevo information, and thus lower secret fraction, at high transmission for fixed asymmetry parameters. However, Fig. 2c reveals that the attenuator channel achieves significantly greater reach (maximum transmission length at which a positive key rate is obtained) than the additive noise channel.

B. Double homodyne

For attenuator channel, from Eq. (50) and (42) we have

$$\Sigma_{AB}^{(\mathcal{E}_{DH})} = \begin{pmatrix} V\mathbb{1} & c \cos \theta_{DH} \sigma_z & 0 \\ c \cos \theta_{DH} \sigma_z & \cos^2 \theta_{DH} \left(V_B + \delta_1 - \frac{e^{2r}}{\cos^2 \theta_{DH}} \right) & 0 \\ 0 & 0 & \cos^2 \theta_{DH} \left(V_B + \delta_2 - \frac{e^{-2r}}{\cos^2 \theta_{DH}} \right) \end{pmatrix} \quad (66)$$

Symplectic eigenvalues of this matrix can be calculated using invariants similarly to Eq. (54). It is obvious that these symplectic eigenvalues, and thereby joint entropy, is explicitly depended on squeezing parameter r (19), like in the case of additive noise channel (see Ref. [23]).

Fig. 3 illustrates dependence of Holevo information on the squeezing parameter, for both additive noise and attenuator channels. Referring to Fig. 3, in the limiting case of ideal double homodyne with $\delta_1 = \delta_2 = 1$, only one value of $r = 0$ is allowed (see Ref. [23]), with equal values of Holevo information for both channels (black dot on plot).

When $\delta_1 = \delta_2 > 1$, dependence of Holevo information on squeezing parameter is symmetrical around $r = 0$ for both channels. For additive noise channel, $r = 0$ is the point of maximal Holevo information, while for attenuator channel $r = 0$ corresponds to minimal Holevo information. Moreover, while Holevo information is undefined at $r = r_{2,1}$ (see Eq. (42)), the values tend to the same values of joint entropy in the case of additive noise channel, as signified by color-matched white-filled dots in Fig. 3.

In asymmetrical case where $\delta_1 \neq \delta_2$, Holevo information for both channel models become asymmetrical relative to their extrema, resulting in unequal joint entropies at $r = r_{2,1}$. For additive noise channel, Holevo information is concave in r , while for attenuator channel it is convex in r .

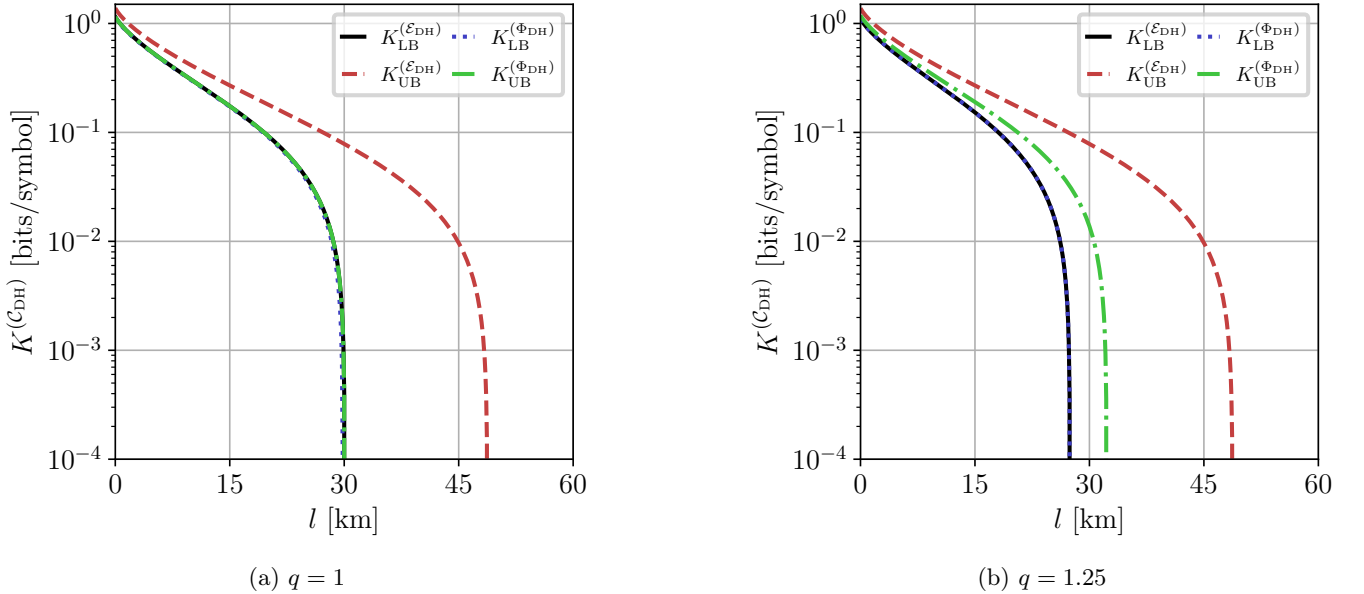


Figure 4: Asymptotic secret fraction $K^{(C_{DH})}$ versus channel length l , computed for fixed $\sigma_x^{(i)} = 1.05$ (see Eq.(14)) and various imbalance ratios $q \equiv \frac{S_S^2}{C_S^2}$ for additive noise and attenuator channel models (see Fig. 3). The parameters are: $V = 5$; $\beta = 0.95$; $\xi_{ch} = 10^{-2}$; losses are 20 dB per 100 km.

Fig. 4 illustrates lower and upper bounds of the asymptotic secret fraction versus transmission length, for both additive noise (51) and attenuator (50) channels. Note that for chosen $\sigma_x^{(i)}$ lower bounds for both channels coincide, because for $\sigma_x^{(i)} \approx 1$ maximum of joint entropy for both models is either at $r = r_1$ or $r = r_2$. Moreover, the upper bound for additive noise channel in Fig. 4a is very close (0.2 km difference) to the lower bound.

As seen from Fig. 4, difference between lower and upper bound of the asymptotic secret fraction is greater in

Fig. 5 illustrates the dependence of Holevo information (52) and asymptotic secret fraction (60) on the signal beam splitter transmission C_S^2 , as well as secret fraction versus transmission length if the receiver uses double homodyne detection, for both additive noise (51) and attenuator (50) channels. Unlike the homodyne detection case (see Fig. 2),

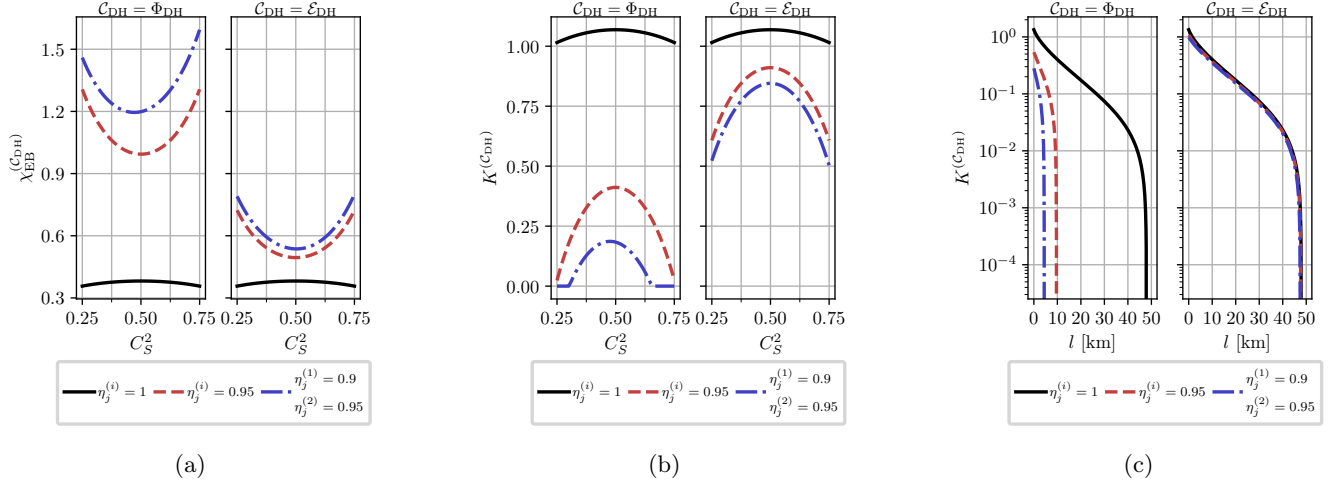


Figure 5: (a) Holevo information, $\chi_{EB}^{(C_{DH})}$ and (b) asymptotic secret fraction, $K^{(C_{DH})}$, as a function of the signal beam splitter transmission, C_S^2 , of the double homodyne receiver computed at different values of the detector efficiencies for additive noise and attenuator channel models, as indicated in panel title. The parameters are: $V = 5$; $T_{ch} = 0.95$; $\xi_{ch} = 10^{-2}$; and $\beta = 0.95$. (c) $K^{(C_{DH})}$ versus transmission length l for additive noise and attenuator channel models. The parameters are: $V = 5$; $\beta = 0.95$; $\xi_{ch} = 10^{-2}$; losses are 20 dB per 100 km.. For both channel models $r = \frac{r_2 + r_1}{2}$ (see main text).

Holevo information is significantly lower for attenuator channel, except for the ideal measurements case ($\eta_{1,2}^{(1,2)} = 1$ and whole C_S^2 axis, unlike in homodyne case where ideal measurements are strictly $\eta_{1,2} = 1$ and $C^2 = 0.5$) as both channels have no effect and thereby have equal joint entropies (black curve). High difference in Holevo information is due to the dependence of joint entropy on r (see Fig. 3) and fixing $r = \frac{r_2 + r_1}{2}$ for both curves, effectively minimizing Holevo information for attenuator channel and maximizing it for additive noise channel.

Analogously to homodyne detection case (see Fig. 2c), in double homodyne detection case the attenuator channel has greater reach than the additive noise channel, as illustrated by Fig. 5c.

V. DISCUSSION AND CONCLUSION

In this paper, we have constructed and compared additive-noise and attenuator channel representations of noisy homodyne and double-homodyne measurements affected by receiver asymmetry. Our approach requires the dual Gaussian channel, together with a deterministic invertible rescaling of the measurement outcomes, to reproduce the target noisy Gaussian measurement. For covariance matrix, this condition is expressed by Eq. (24). It determines the channel parameters from the receiver parameters and, for double-homodyne detection, also from the selected Gaussian seed.

After the deterministic invertible rescaling of the measurement outcomes, the two realizations reproduce the same conditional statistics of Bob's outcomes. They therefore give the same Alice-Bob mutual information. For fixed source and channel parameters, the conditional covariance matrix in Eq. (57), and hence the conditional entropy $S_{A|B}$, are the same for the two realizations because the detector imperfections enter the conditional state through the same noisy measurement. The difference between the security estimates originates from the joint state of Alice and Bob. The additive-noise and attenuator channels generally produce different joint covariance matrices and, consequently, different joint entropies. In the untrusted-noise scenario considered here, the environment associated with the detector and channel is assigned to Eve. The corresponding Holevo information, $\chi_{EB} = S_{AB} - S_{A|B}$, therefore depends on the selected channel realization even when Bob's observed statistics remain unchanged.

For homodyne detection, we take the attenuator environment to be in the vacuum state, so that the detector imperfections are represented by a pure-loss channel. Within the combined channel-detector model, this realization rescales both the effective transmission and the output-referred excess noise by the same factor, as shown in Eq. (64).

The numerical results in Fig. 2 show that the additive-noise and attenuator realizations are not uniformly ordered. At high channel transmittance and for the parameters considered, the attenuator realization gives a larger Holevo information and a lower asymptotic secret fraction. At longer distances, however, the secret fraction remains positive up to a greater channel length than in the additive-noise realization. Therefore, neither realization can be described

as uniformly more or less pessimistic. Their ordering is therefore not uniform over the parameter regimes considered.

A distinguishing feature of double-homodyne detection is the nonuniqueness of the representation of its noisy POVM. The covariance matrix of the physical double-homodyne measurement is fixed by the receiver parameters and does not depend on the squeezing parameter r . The parameter r labels the ideal pure Gaussian seed measurement used in the decomposition of this fixed POVM into an ideal measurement and a preceding Gaussian channel. The requirement that the excess-noise covariance matrix be positive semidefinite restricts r to the interval given by Eq. (19).

For the additive-noise realization, variation of r redistributes the measurement noise between the two conjugate quadratures according to Eq. (31). For the attenuator realization, the same variation changes both the attenuation coefficient and the covariance matrix of the environmental state, as described by Eqs. (42) and (43). In the attenuator construction adopted here, the generally anisotropic measurement noise is reproduced by an anisotropic Gaussian environment, which was chosen to be pure.

At the boundaries of the admissible interval of the squeezing parameter r , one of the additive-noise quadrature variances vanishes. In the attenuator realization, the environmental state approaches an infinitely squeezed limit: one quadrature variance tends to zero, whereas the conjugate variance diverges. The boundary points are therefore understood as limiting realizations in which the attenuator result approaches the corresponding additive-noise result.

Figure 3 shows that the Holevo information depends on r in qualitatively different ways for the two channel realizations. For the parameter regimes considered, this dependence is concave for the additive-noise realization and convex for the attenuator realization. When the measurement noise is symmetric between the two quadratures, both curves are symmetric about $r = 0$. In this case, the unsqueezed seed, $r = 0$, maximizes the Holevo information for the additive-noise realization and minimizes it for the attenuator realization. For the asymmetric case considered, this symmetry is lost and the extrema are shifted away from $r = 0$.

The lower and upper secret-fraction curves in Fig. 4 describe the range obtained by varying r over its admissible interval for each channel realization. For the near-ideal quadrature variances used in Fig. 4, the lower bounds of the two realizations nearly coincide because the Holevo-information maximum occurs at, or close to, the interval boundaries. The upper bounds become more clearly separated when the imbalance of the signal beam splitter is increased.

The comparison shown in Fig. 5 was performed at the midpoint of the admissible interval of r . In the symmetric case, this value coincides with the maximum of the additive-noise Holevo information and the minimum of the attenuator Holevo information. The pronounced separation between the secret fractions in Fig. 5 therefore reflects both the selected channel realization and the selected seed parameter.

These results clarify the role of the detector-channel representation in the untrusted-noise model. Although the additive-noise and attenuator descriptions reproduce the same receiver statistics after outcome rescaling, they generally yield different joint states of Alice and Bob and different outputs assigned to Eve. The selected representation therefore introduces a physical assumption about the coupling between the optical signal and the inaccessible degrees of freedom.

A security estimate should not be based on a particular representation solely because it gives a larger secret fraction. The selected detector-channel model should either be justified from the physical structure of the receiver or treated conservatively over the realizations included in the analysis. The present comparison is restricted to the additive-noise realization and to attenuator realizations with pure Gaussian environmental states. Mixed environmental states and other Gaussian channel constructions compatible with the same receiver statistics were not considered.

Appendix A extends the receiver model to include independent pure losses at the output ports of a lossless beam splitter. These losses can be incorporated into the effective photodetector efficiencies. By contrast, a general lossy asymmetric beam splitter with unequal complex transmission and reflection amplitudes does not, in general, preserve the simple quadrature form of the receiver response and cannot be included by merely replacing the detector efficiencies.

The security analysis was performed for the asymptotic GMCS CV-QKD protocol under collective attacks, with receiver equipment treated as untrusted. Trusted receiver noise, finite-size corrections, active detector attacks, and uncertainties in the calibration parameters require separate treatment. Within these assumptions, equivalent receiver statistics can lead to different estimates of Eve's information when they are represented by different untrusted detector channels.

ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

The work was supported by the Russian Science Foundation (project No. [24-11-00398](#)).

Appendix A: Lossy beamsplitter

In this appendix, we show that applying independent pure loss channels at the output ports of a lossless beam splitter yields the exact same transformation as a single formally defined lossy beam splitter.

First, consider homodyne detection case depicted in Fig. ?? The lossless unbalanced beam splitter mixing the input signal mode $\hat{a}$ and the local oscillator mode $\hat{a}_L$. This transformation is described by the unitary rotation matrix $\mathbf{U}_{\text{BS}}$,

$$\begin{aligned} \begin{pmatrix} \hat{a}_1 \\ \hat{a}_2 \end{pmatrix} &= \mathbf{U}_{\text{BS}} \begin{pmatrix} \hat{a} \\ \hat{a}_L \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} C & S \\ -S & C \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \hat{a} \\ \hat{a}_L \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} C\hat{a} + S\hat{a}_L \\ -S\hat{a} + C\hat{a}_L \end{pmatrix}, \end{aligned} \quad (\text{A1})$$

where C and S are the transmission and reflection coefficients of the beamsplitter BS, respectively.

We model the subsequent losses by passing each intermediate output mode $\hat{a}_{1,2}$ through a virtual beam splitter of transmittance $\tau_{1,2}$. This mixes each signal with an independent environmental vacuum mode $\hat{v}_{1,2}$, where $[\hat{v}_i, \hat{v}_j^\dagger] = \delta_{ij}$,

$$\begin{pmatrix} \hat{b}_1 \\ \hat{c}_1 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \sqrt{\tau_1} & -\sqrt{1-\tau_1} \\ \sqrt{1-\tau_1} & \sqrt{\tau_1} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \hat{a}_1 \\ \hat{v}_1 \end{pmatrix}, \quad (\text{A2})$$

$$\begin{pmatrix} \hat{b}_2 \\ \hat{c}_2 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \sqrt{\tau_2} & -\sqrt{1-\tau_2} \\ \sqrt{1-\tau_2} & \sqrt{\tau_2} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \hat{a}_2 \\ \hat{v}_2 \end{pmatrix}. \quad (\text{A3})$$

Tracing out the lost environmental modes $\hat{c}_{1,2}$, the remaining physical output modes $\hat{b}_{1,2}$ expand to

$$\begin{pmatrix} \hat{b}_1 \\ \hat{b}_2 \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \sqrt{\tau_1}C & \sqrt{\tau_1}S \\ -\sqrt{\tau_2}S & \sqrt{\tau_2}C \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} \hat{a} \\ \hat{a}_L \end{pmatrix} + \begin{pmatrix} -\sqrt{1-\tau_1}\hat{v}_1 \\ -\sqrt{1-\tau_2}\hat{v}_2 \end{pmatrix}. \quad (\text{A4})$$

From Eq. (A4), we extract the effective scattering matrix $\mathbf{T}_{\text{BS}}$ and the fluctuation noise operators $\hat{F}_{1,2}$ representing the device excitations

$$\mathbf{T}_{\text{BS}} = \begin{pmatrix} \sqrt{\tau_1}C & \sqrt{\tau_1}S \\ -\sqrt{\tau_2}S & \sqrt{\tau_2}C \end{pmatrix}. \quad (\text{A5})$$

It is not difficult to show that to preserve the Canonical Commutation Relations for the output fields, $[\hat{b}_i, \hat{b}_j^\dagger] = \delta_{ij}$, the noise operators $\hat{F}_{1,2}$ must satisfy

$$[\hat{F}_i, \hat{F}_j^\dagger] = \delta_{ij} - \sum_k T_{ik} T_{jk}^*, \quad (\text{A6})$$

where T_{ik} are the elements of the scattering matrix $\mathbf{T}_{\text{BS}}$ (A5). Evaluating this constraint explicitly using the elements of $\mathbf{T}_{\text{BS}}$ yields:

$$[\hat{F}_1, \hat{F}_1^\dagger] = 1 - \tau_1, \quad (\text{A7})$$

$$[\hat{F}_2, \hat{F}_2^\dagger] = 1 - \tau_2, \quad (\text{A8})$$

$$[\hat{F}_1, \hat{F}_2^\dagger] = 0, \quad (\text{A9})$$

which matches the commutators calculated from definitions (??).

We now connect this setup to the formal, standard mathematical treatment of lossy beam splitters [31, 32]. This framework models loss via an interaction matrix $\mathbf{A}$ acting on ancillary modes, which must obey the positivity condition $\mathbf{1} - \mathbf{A}\mathbf{A}^\dagger \geq 0$ to satisfy unitarity. Note that the extracted scattering matrix $\mathbf{T}_{\text{BS}}$ (A5) can be factored into a product of a diagonal scaling matrix and the lossless unitary,

$$\begin{aligned} \mathbf{T}_{\text{BS}} &= \begin{pmatrix} \sqrt{\tau_1} & 0 \\ 0 & \sqrt{\tau_2} \end{pmatrix} \begin{pmatrix} C & S \\ -S & C \end{pmatrix} \\ &= \begin{pmatrix} \sqrt{\tau_1} & 0 \\ 0 & \sqrt{\tau_2} \end{pmatrix} \mathbf{U}_{\text{BS}}. \end{aligned} \quad (\text{A10})$$

By defining the positive semi-definite matrix representing the loss properties as $\mathbf{A}\mathbf{A}^\dagger = \text{diag}(1 - \tau_1, 1 - \tau_2)$, it follows that:

$$\sqrt{\mathbf{1} - \mathbf{A}\mathbf{A}^\dagger} = \begin{pmatrix} \sqrt{\tau_1} & 0 \\ 0 & \sqrt{\tau_2} \end{pmatrix}. \quad (\text{A11})$$

Substituting this back into Eq. (A10) yields the polar decomposition of the scattering matrix of a lossy beam splitter in its generalized form [32]:

$$\mathbf{T}_{\text{BS}} = \sqrt{\mathbf{1} - \mathbf{A}\mathbf{A}^\dagger} \mathbf{U}_{\text{BS}}. \quad (\text{A12})$$

Because the matrix $\mathbf{A}\mathbf{A}^\dagger$ representing the losses is diagonal, it is straightforward to see that to account for lossy beamsplitter in a homodyne setup it is sufficient to simply rescale the quantum efficiencies of detection: $\eta_{1,2} \rightarrow \tau_{1,2}\eta_{1,2}$. The same argument would apply in the case of double homodyne detection.

We conclude this appendix by discussing the generalized (asymmetrical) beamsplitter model where input ports of the beamsplitter are characterized by different set of transmission and reflection coefficients. In this case, the non-unitary scattering matrix is written in the form [33]

$$\mathbf{S} = \begin{pmatrix} t & \rho \\ r & \tau \end{pmatrix}, \quad \mathbf{S}\mathbf{S}^\dagger \leq \mathbf{1}, \quad (\text{A13})$$

where t, τ (r, ρ) are complex transmission (reflection) coefficients. While it can be factored into lossy and unitary parts similarly to (A12), **this case cannot be covered by the formulas after some replacement, because it ruins quadrature representation:**

$$|\alpha, \alpha_L\rangle \mapsto |\alpha_1, \alpha_2\rangle, \quad (\text{A14})$$

$$\alpha_1 = t\alpha + \rho\alpha_L, \quad \alpha_2 = r\alpha + \tau\alpha_L, \quad (\text{A15})$$

$$P_G(\mu) = G(\mu - \mu_G; \sigma_G), \quad (\text{A16})$$

$$\begin{aligned} \sigma_G &= \eta_1 |\alpha_1|^2 + \eta_2 |\alpha_2|^2 \\ &= (\eta_1 |\rho|^2 + \eta_2 |\tau|^2) |\alpha_L|^2 + (\eta_1 |t|^2 + \eta_2 |r|^2) |\alpha|^2 \\ &\quad + 2 \text{Re}[(\eta_1 t \rho^* + \eta_2 r \tau^*) \alpha \alpha_L^*] \\ &\approx (\eta_1 |\rho|^2 + \eta_2 |\tau|^2) |\alpha_L|^2 + 2 \text{Re}[(\eta_1 t \rho^* + \eta_2 r \tau^*) \alpha \alpha_L^*], \end{aligned} \quad (\text{A17})$$

$$\begin{aligned} \mu_G &= \eta_1 |\alpha_1|^2 - \eta_2 |\alpha_2|^2 \\ &= (\eta_1 |\rho|^2 - \eta_2 |\tau|^2) |\alpha_L|^2 + (\eta_1 |t|^2 - \eta_2 |r|^2) |\alpha|^2 \\ &\quad + 2 \text{Re}[(\eta_1 t \rho^* - \eta_2 r \tau^*) \alpha \alpha_L^*] \\ &\approx (\eta_1 |\rho|^2 - \eta_2 |\tau|^2) |\alpha_L|^2 + 2 \text{Re}[(\eta_1 t \rho^* - \eta_2 r \tau^*) \alpha \alpha_L^*]. \end{aligned} \quad (\text{A18})$$

Appendix B: Fluctuating Local Oscillator

In this Appendix, we extend the theoretical treatment of homodyne measurements to account for classical intensity fluctuations of the local oscillator (LO).

We start from the Gaussian approximation of the photon count difference probability distribution in homodyne scheme [23]

$$P_G(\mu) = G(\mu - \mu_G; \sigma_G), \quad (\text{B1})$$

$$\sigma_G = \eta_1 |\alpha_1|^2 + \eta_2 |\alpha_2|^2 \approx (\eta_1 S^2 + \eta_2 C^2) |\alpha_L|^2, \quad (\text{B2})$$

$$\mu_G = \eta_1 |\alpha_1|^2 - \eta_2 |\alpha_2|^2 \approx (\eta_1 S^2 - \eta_2 C^2) |\alpha_L|^2 + CS(\eta_1 + \eta_2) |\alpha_L| \langle \hat{x}_\phi \rangle, \quad (\text{B3})$$

where

$$G(x; \sigma) \equiv \frac{1}{\sqrt{2\pi\sigma}} \exp\left(-\frac{x^2}{2\sigma}\right). \quad (\text{B4})$$

We assume that the LO amplitude fluctuates around its mean value α_L such that

$$\alpha_L = \alpha_L + \delta\alpha_L, \quad \delta\alpha_L \sim G(\delta\alpha_L, \sigma_L) \quad (\text{B5})$$

where σ_{LO} represents the variance of the LO amplitude fluctuations.

To find the total probability distribution $P_{\text{tot}}(\mu)$ that accounts for the local oscillator fluctuations, we perform an ensemble average by integrating the conditional distribution $P_G(\mu)$ over the Gaussian prior of the LO amplitude.

$$P_{\text{total}}(\mu) = \int d\delta\alpha_L P_G(\mu|\delta\alpha_L) P_G(\delta\alpha_L) = \quad (\text{B6})$$

S

-
- [1] U. Leonhardt, *Measuring the Quantum State of Light*, Cambridge Studies in Modern Optics (Cambridge University Press, Cambridge, 1997) p. 193.
 - [2] S. L. Braunstein and P. van Loock, Quantum information with continuous variables, *Rev. Mod. Phys.* **77**, 513 (2005).
 - [3] C. Weedbrook, S. Pirandola, R. García-Patrón, N. J. Cerf, T. C. Ralph, J. H. Shapiro, and S. Lloyd, Gaussian quantum information, *Rev. Mod. Phys.* **84**, 621 (2012).
 - [4] F. Grosshans and P. Grangier, Continuous variable quantum cryptography using coherent states, *Phys. Rev. Lett.* **88**, 057902 (2002).
 - [5] S. Pirandola, U. L. Andersen, L. Banchi, M. Berta, D. Bunandar, R. Colbeck, D. Englund, T. Gehring, C. Lupo, C. Ottaviani, J. L. Pereira, M. Razavi, J. S. Shaari, M. Tomamichel, V. C. Usenko, G. Vallone, P. Villoresi, and P. Wallden, Advances in quantum cryptography, *Adv. Opt. Photon.* **12**, 1012 (2020).
 - [6] Y. Zhang, Y. Bian, Z. Li, S. Yu, and H. Guo, Continuous-variable quantum key distribution system: Past, present, and future, *Applied Physics Reviews* **11**, 011318 (2024).
 - [7] G. M. D'Ariano, M. G. Paris, and M. F. Sacchi, Quantum tomography, *Advances in imaging and electron physics* **128**, S1076 (2003).
 - [8] A. I. Lvovsky and M. G. Raymer, Continuous-variable optical quantum-state tomography, *Rev. Mod. Phys.* **81**, 299 (2009).
 - [9] Y.-L. Zhang, C.-S. Yang, C.-L. Zou, T. Xia, G.-C. Guo, and X.-B. Zou, Quantum state preparation of an atomic ensemble via cavity-assisted homodyne measurement, *Journal of Physics B: Atomic, Molecular and Optical Physics* **52**, 215003 (2019).
 - [10] D. Pereira, M. Almeida, M. Facão, A. N. Pinto, and N. A. Silva, Impact of receiver imbalances on the security of continuous variables quantum key distribution, *EPJ Quantum Technology* **8**, 10.1140/epjqt/s40507-021-00112-z (2021).
 - [11] A. Barchielli and A. Santamato, Eight-port homodyne detector: The effect of imperfections on quantum random-number generation and on detection of quadratures, *Physical Review A* **106**, 10.1103/physreva.106.022620 (2022).
 - [12] C. Lupo and Y. Ouyang, Quantum key distribution with nonideal heterodyne detection: Composable security of discrete-modulation continuous-variable protocols, *PRX Quantum* **3**, 010341 (2022).
 - [13] A. A. Hajomer, A. N. Oruganti, I. Derkach, U. L. Andersen, V. C. Usenko, and T. Gehring, Finite-size security of continuous-variable quantum key distribution with imperfect heterodyne measurement, *arXiv preprint arXiv:2501.10278* (2025).
 - [14] J. O. Bartlett, A. J. M. Wilson, C. J. Chunnillall, and R. Kumar, Detector asymmetry in continuous variable quantum key distribution, *arXiv preprint arXiv:2510.17419* (2025).
 - [15] A. S. Holevo and V. Giovannetti, Quantum channels and their entropic characteristics, *Reports on Progress in Physics* **75**, 046001 (2012).
 - [16] A. Serafini, *Quantum Continuous Variables: A Primer of Theoretical Methods*, 2nd ed. (CRC Press, Taylor & Francis Group, Boca Raton, 2023) p. 362.
 - [17] S. Yamano, T. Matsuura, Y. Kuramochi, T. Sasaki, and M. Koashi, General treatment of gaussian trusted noise in continuous variable quantum key distribution (2023), *arXiv:2305.17684* [quant-ph].
 - [18] V. C. Usenko and R. Filip, Trusted noise in continuous-variable quantum key distribution: a threat and a defense, *Entropy* **18**, 20 (2016).
 - [19] F. Laudenbach, C. Pacher, C.-H. F. Fung, A. Poppe, M. Peev, B. Schrenk, M. Hentschel, P. Walther, and H. Hübel, Continuous-variable quantum key distribution with gaussian modulation—the theory of practical implementations, *Advanced Quantum Technologies* **1**, 1800011 (2018).
 - [20] F. Laudenbach and C. Pacher, Analysis of the trusted-device scenario in continuous-variable quantum key distribution, *Advanced Quantum Technologies* **2**, 1900055 (2019).
 - [21] S. Pan, D. Monokandylos, and B. Qi, Detector noise in continuous-variable quantum key distribution, *Physical Review A* **112**, 10.1103/4h84-5tsg (2025).
 - [22] G. Staffieri, G. Scala, and C. Lupo, Finite-size secret-key rates of discrete modulation continuous-variable quantum key distribution under gaussian attacks, *Physical Review A* **113**, 10.1103/rwq3-plm6 (2026).
 - [23] A. S. Naumchik, R. K. Goncharov, and A. D. Kiselev, Asymmetry effects in homodyne and heterodyne measurements: Positive operator-valued measures and asymptotic security of gaussian continuous variable quantum key distribution (2025), *arXiv:2512.22591* [quant-ph].

- [24] F. Grosshans and P. Grangier, Continuous variable quantum cryptography using coherent states, *Phys. Rev. Lett.* **88**, 057902 (2002).
- [25] M. Navascués, F. Grosshans, and A. Acín, Optimality of gaussian attacks in continuous-variable quantum cryptography, *Physical Review Letters* **97**, 190502 (2006).
- [26] R. García-Patrón and N. J. Cerf, Unconditional optimality of gaussian attacks against continuous-variable quantum key distribution, *Physical Review Letters* **97**, 190503 (2006).
- [27] M. A. Nielsen and I. L. Chuang, *Quantum Computation and Quantum Information*, 10th ed. (Cambridge University Press, NY, 2010) p. 676.
- [28] C. Weedbrook, S. Pirandola, R. García-Patrón, N. J. Cerf, T. C. Ralph, J. H. Shapiro, and S. Lloyd, Gaussian quantum information, *Rev. Mod. Phys.* **84**, 621 (2012).
- [29] F. Laudenbach, C. Pacher, C.-H. F. Fung, A. Poppe, M. Peev, B. Schrenk, M. Hentschel, P. Walther, and H. Hübel, Continuous-variable quantum key distribution with Gaussian modulation—the theory of practical implementations, *Advanced Quantum Technologies* **1**, 1800011 (2018).
- [30] I. Devetak and A. Winter, Distillation of secret key and entanglement from quantum states, *Proceedings of the Royal Society A: Mathematical, Physical and Engineering Sciences* **461**, 207 (2005).
- [31] S. M. Barnett, J. Jeffers, A. Gatti, and R. Loudon, Quantum optics of lossy beam splitters, *Physical Review A* **57**, 2134–2145 (1998).
- [32] L. Knöll, S. Scheel, E. Schmidt, D.-G. Welsch, and A. V. Chizhov, Quantum-state transformation by dispersive and absorbing four-port devices, *Physical Review A* **59**, 4716–4726 (1999).
- [33] R. Uppu, T. A. W. Wolterink, T. B. H. Tentrup, and P. W. H. Pinkse, Quantum optics of lossy asymmetric beam splitters, *Optics Express* **24**, 16440 (2016).